

G1 is pretty slick, easy to use and supports H.263, H.264 (in 3GP or MP4 container), MPEG-4 SP, AMR, AMR-WB (in 3GP container), AAC, HE-AAC (in MP4 or 3GP container) formats.

Many free applications are available on Android market which escalate the multimedia experience on Android OS, further videos in almost any format can be viewed using these apps.

To Developers

In Android developers have full access to the same framework APIs used by the core applications. The application architecture is designed to abridge the reuse of components; any application can publish its capabilities and any other application may then make use of those capabilities (subject to security constraints enforced by the framework). This same mechanism allows objects to be replaced by the user. Also, in development of the presentation of the application (UI), Android provides an alternate UI construction model: XML-based layout files. This structure makes it very easy to quickly build up UIs, using a much simpler structure and syntax than the source code. This model is inspired by the web development model, where you can separate the UI from the application logic used to fetch and fill in data. These unique features open up a huge avenue of possibilities for developers. For example, with Android, a developer can easily develop an application that enables users to view the location of their friends and be alerted when they are in the vicinity. Such kind of application will be extremely difficult to build using another OS platforms since control to core system processes is limited in them.

Since most of the Android is open source, vendors are at liberty to modify it. This has greatly empowered the vendors as they can tweak the OS itself to their hardware specifications, which in turn greatly enhances the device's performance. Moreover end users themselves can tweak the applications to their liking.

Android includes a set of C/C++ libraries used by various components of the Android system. These capabilities are exposed to developers through the Android application framework. Mentionable core libraries are:

System C library

A BSD-derived implementation of the standard C system library (libc), tuned for embedded Linux-based devices.

Media libraries

Based on PacketVideo's OpenCORE; the libraries support playback and recording of many popular audio and video formats, as well as static image files.